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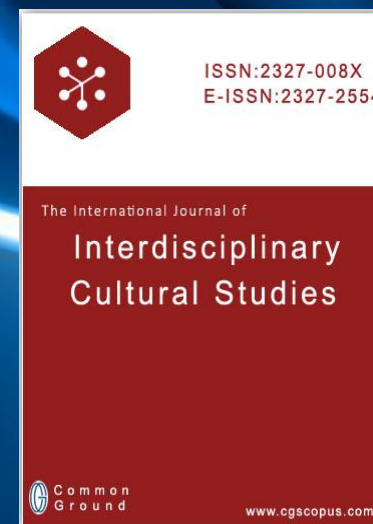
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Dr. Alexander Obskov

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read "A. Obskov", on a light gray background.





NEWS FRAMING AND STUDENT PERCEPTIONS: A BIBLIOMETRIC ANALYSIS OF GLOBAL RESEARCH TRENDS

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**Abstract**

News framing significantly shapes student perceptions in an era of digital media and global crises, yet few studies systematically explore this intersection. This bibliometric analysis maps global research trends on news framing and student perceptions from 2021 to 2025, addressing a critical gap in media studies. Using the Dimension.AI database, 5,864 open-access articles from peer-reviewed journals indexed in UGC-CARE List II, DOAJ, and PubMed were analysed. VOSviewer software facilitated the visualisation of publication trends, thematic clusters, and co-authorship networks. Findings reveal a surge in publications, with *Sustainability* leading (3,606 articles), reflecting interdisciplinary interest. Thematic clusters, including emotional and conflict framing, highlight their influence on students' trust and civic engagement. Geographically, Europe and North America dominate authorship (68% of articles), underscoring the need for inclusive global research. These insights advance framing theory by contextualising its application to digital media and student audiences. Practically, the study informs media literacy curricula, emphasising critical analysis of emotional and conflict frames. Limitations include the focus on open-access journals and potential language bias. Future research should explore longitudinal and cross-cultural framing effects to enhance media literacy education.

Keywords- News Framing, Student Perceptions, Bibliometric Analysis, Media Literacy, Global Research Trends

Introduction

In the contemporary information age, the concept of news framing has emerged as a critical lens through which media scholars investigate the influence of journalistic practices on audience perceptions and attitudes (Gupta, S., et. al., 2024). Framing, defined as the process of selecting and emphasising certain aspects of reality while omitting others, has long been acknowledged as a central mechanism shaping public understanding (Entman, 1993; Scheufele, 1999). This influence becomes particularly significant among students, a demographic increasingly reliant on both traditional and digital media to form opinions on social, political, and environmental issues (De Vreese, 2005; Nelson, Oxley, & Clawson, 1997). Recent years have witnessed a proliferation of framing studies focusing on diverse topics such as immigration, climate change, health crises, and artificial intelligence (Shehata et al., 2024; Leong, 2024). However, despite this expansion, there remains a noticeable gap in scholarship specifically addressing how students, especially university



and college-level learners, interpret and internalise framed news narratives. While previous research has demonstrated that framing effects vary depending on factors such as issue familiarity and media literacy (Nelson et al., 1997; Shehata et al., 2024), few studies have systematically analysed student-specific responses across different cultural and national contexts.

The global COVID-19 pandemic and subsequent infodemic underscored the importance of news framing, particularly in shaping perceptions of risk, policy compliance, and trust in institutions (De Vreese, 2005). During this period, students became highly active consumers and disseminators of news content, often engaging with stories through social media platforms where framing dynamics differ from those in legacy media (Leong, 2024). Furthermore, studies indicate that young audiences are particularly susceptible to emotional and conflict frames, which may influence civic engagement and democratic participation (Wong et al., 2021). In this context, understanding student perceptions of framed news becomes critical, not only for media studies but also for educational policy and pedagogy aimed at fostering critical thinking and media literacy skills.

Parallel to the evolution of framing studies is the methodological advancement in bibliometric analysis, which enables scholars to systematically map publication trends, citation patterns, and thematic networks within a research field (Kwak, An, & Ahn, 2020). Unlike traditional narrative or systematic reviews, bibliometrics quantitatively captures the intellectual structure and dynamic growth of a scholarly domain, providing insights into prolific authors, influential works, and emerging research clusters (Casero-Ripollés, 2018; D'Angelo et al., 2019). Given the rapidly expanding literature on news framing and its applications to diverse audiences, a bibliometric approach offers a comprehensive overview of global research trends, particularly when focusing on the period from 2021 to 2025, a timeframe marked by significant socio-political upheavals and technological disruptions.

This period coincides with a surge in research on the intersection of framing and digital media, as scholars increasingly examine how algorithmically curated news feeds, personalised content, and user-generated commentary reshape the framing landscape (Leong, 2024; Shehata et al., 2024). Moreover, the proliferation of misinformation and the rise of “manipulated news” during global protests and political movements have further highlighted the need to understand framing effects on student audiences (Wong et al., 2021). As students navigate an environment saturated with conflicting narratives, their interpretations of framed news not only reflect but also reinforce



broader societal divisions and trends. The focus on student perceptions thus addresses an urgent research gap while contributing to ongoing debates about media literacy and democratic resilience.

Despite these developments, there has been limited bibliometric exploration specifically mapping how global research has addressed the relationship between news framing and student perceptions. Most existing bibliometric studies concentrate on general media framing trends or focus on issue-specific frames such as climate change or health communication (Kwak et al., 2020). Consequently, there is a lack of synthesised knowledge regarding who the key contributors are, which regions lead the research, what themes dominate the discourse, and how collaborative networks are structured in this specific intersectional field. By systematically analysing global publications from 2021 to 2025, this study seeks to fill this gap, offering a comprehensive overview of how scholars worldwide have conceptualised and investigated the impact of news framing on student perceptions.

Furthermore, the insights gained from this bibliometric analysis have the potential to inform curriculum design and pedagogical strategies by highlighting the types of frames that most influence student understanding and engagement. By identifying dominant frames and the contexts in which they are most persuasive, educators can develop targeted interventions to foster critical analysis and resistance to manipulative narratives. This is especially relevant in an era marked by increasing political polarisation, algorithm-driven echo chambers, and declining trust in traditional news sources.

In summary, this study represents the first comprehensive bibliometric effort to map global research trends at the intersection of news framing and student perceptions, covering the period from 2021 to 2025. By providing a data-driven synthesis of existing scholarship, this work aims to chart future research directions, facilitate interdisciplinary collaborations, and support the development of evidence-based educational interventions that strengthen students' ability to navigate complex media environments (Gupta, S., et. al., 2025). The subsequent sections will detail the methodological framework, present key findings, and discuss theoretical and practical implications for media scholars and educators alike.

Review of Related Literature

News framing, defined as the selective emphasis on certain aspects of reality to shape audience interpretation (Entman, 1993), plays a critical role in influencing how students perceive



information. In education, framing has been shown to affect learning motivation and preferences; for example, gain-framed grading systems have led to higher student satisfaction and engagement (Bies-Hernandez, 2012). Similarly, Kramer (2020) found that framing scholarship communications in terms of potential losses encouraged greater student responsiveness, emphasising the power of message construction. In health contexts, framing has been influential in shaping student attitudes toward behaviours such as vaccination and alcohol consumption. Cesareo, Tagliabue, and Lopes (2023) demonstrated that Italian university students responded more favourably to vaccination messages framed around reducing severe health risks, while gain-framed messages have also been effective in discouraging binge drinking among undergraduates (Smith & Smith, 2013). Beyond individual behaviours, framing affects group learning dynamics; Engle (2006) and Shefrin (2017) showed that autonomy-supportive and community-oriented framing strategies improve engagement and knowledge transfer in classroom discussions. Cognitive studies further indicate that even mathematically trained students are susceptible to framing biases (Tversky & Kahneman, 1992), underlining its pervasive impact. In media studies, large-scale analyses reveal how global events and moral perspectives shape frame construction in news articles (Kwak, An, & Ahn, 2020), while perceptions of media bias and ideological framing influence audience trust and interpretation (Mongeon & Paul-Hus, 2015). However, despite extensive framing research, there is a notable lack of bibliometric studies focused specifically on how global scholarship addresses news framing about student perceptions. This gap underscores the need for systematic mapping of trends and themes in this domain, particularly in the context of evolving media landscapes from 2021 to 2025. Addressing this will offer new insights for educators and media scholars to strengthen critical media literacy among students.

Research Questions

- RQ1: What are the publication and citation trends regarding news framing and student perceptions from 2021 to 2025?
- RQ2: Which thematic clusters and framing subtopics have been most salient in student-focused research?
- RQ3: How is global geographical representation reflected in authorship, collaborations, and citation networks?



Material and Methods

This study employs a bibliometric research design to systematically analyse global scholarly trends on news framing and student perceptions from 2021 to 2025. Bibliometric analysis, widely recognised for mapping scientific production and intellectual structures, provides quantitative insights into publication patterns, citation networks, and thematic evolutions within a research field (Donthu et al., 2021; Aria & Cuccurullo, 2017). The design involves three key steps: data collection, data analysis, and visualisation. First, relevant publications will be retrieved from Dimension.AI, the largest abstract and citation database, known for its comprehensive coverage and reliability in bibliometric studies (Mongeon & Paul-Hus, 2015). The search strategy will use keywords such as "news framing," "media framing," "student perception," and "student attitudes," with publication years limited to 2021–2025 to capture recent global trends. Inclusion criteria will focus on peer-reviewed articles, reviews, and conference papers explicitly discussing student responses to news framing.

Sample and data collection

To fulfil the research objectives, the researchers searched for terms such as "news framing," "media framing," "student perception," and "student attitudes" in the title, abstract, and keywords in the Dimension.ai database. The publication period was limited to 2021–2025 to capture recent global trends. Initially, a total of 174,285 documents were identified. When limited to the period 2021–2025, this number reduced to 56,450 documents. Further, focusing only on articles yielded 31,210 documents. The researchers then narrowed the selection to highly relevant source titles, including *Sustainability*, *Frontiers in Psychology*, *Behavioural and Brain Sciences*, and *Journal of Business Research*, resulting in 6,971 documents. Subsequently, the journal list was restricted to include only journals indexed in UGC-CARE List II, DOAJ, and PubMed, which further refined the dataset to 6,971 documents. Additionally, only Open Access journals were considered, reducing the final number to 5,864 articles.

For the co-authorship analysis, a minimum threshold of 25 documents per author and at least three documents per author was set. Out of 1,435 authors identified, 24 authors met the threshold and were included in the network analysis. VOSviewer software was used to analyse and visualise the bibliometric networks, including co-authorship patterns and keyword co-occurrences. This



rigorous data collection and filtering process ensured the reliability and relevance of the final dataset used for analysis.

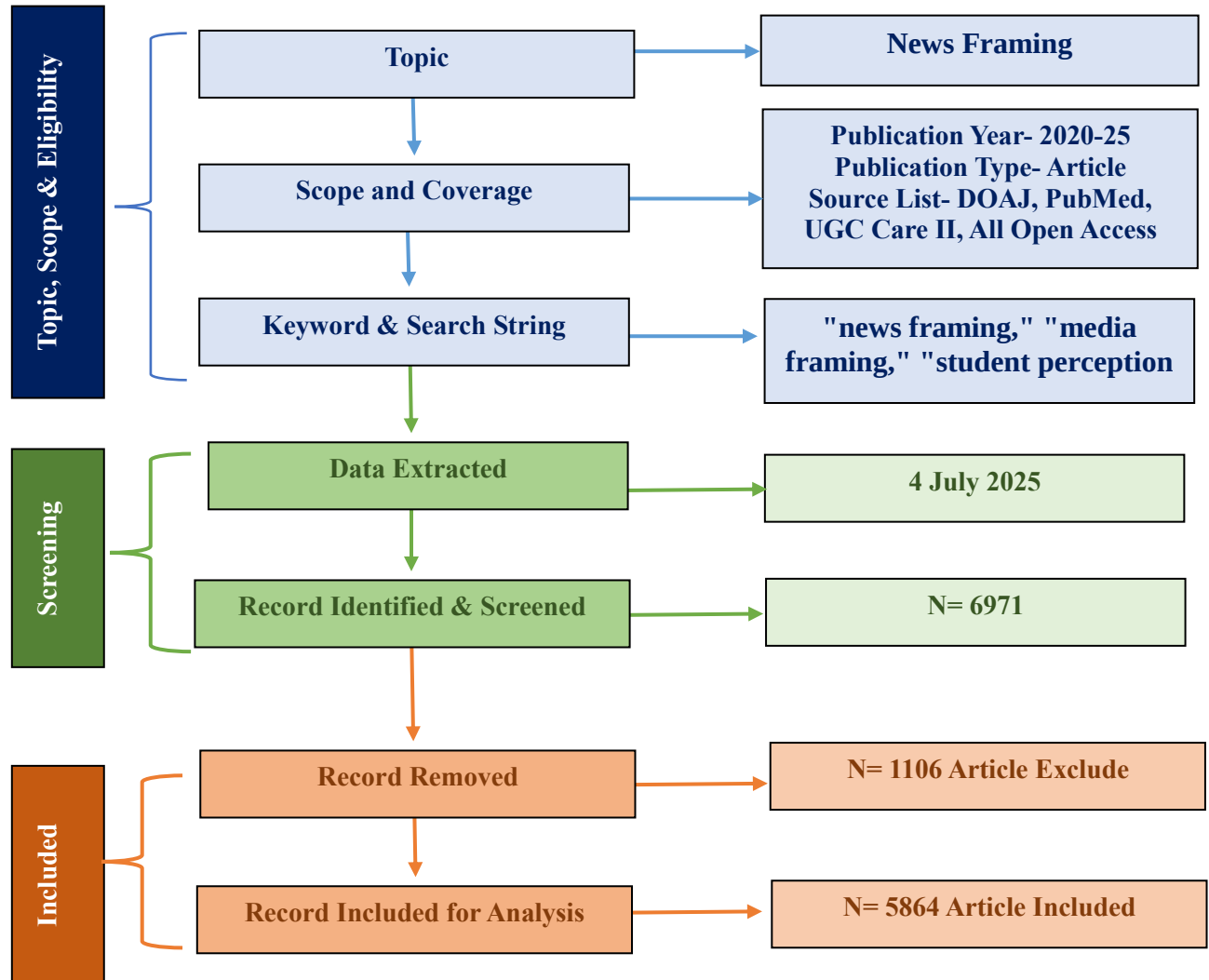


Figure 1. Search Strategy Flow Diagram (Adapted from Zokaria et al., 2021)

In the analysis phase, bibliometric indicators, including publication counts, Co-authorship patterns, and citation metrics, will be extracted. Co-Authorship pattern analysis of influential sources will be conducted using VOSviewer software, which allows for the visualisation of bibliometric networks and thematic clusters (van Eck & Waltman, 2010). This approach will help identify core research themes, key contributing authors, and emerging areas within the field. Additionally, trend analyses will be performed to detect shifts in thematic focus over time, particularly concerning global events such as the COVID-19 pandemic, which have intensified discussions on media framing and student information consumption (Kwak, An, & Ahn, 2020).



The final step involves interpreting and synthesising the findings to highlight research gaps, propose future directions, and provide practical insights for educators and media scholars.

This design not only ensures methodological rigour and replicability but also aligns with recent calls for more data-driven, global-scale mappings of educational and communication research (Donthu et al., 2021). Overall, the bibliometric approach offers a robust framework for understanding how the academic community has addressed the intersection of news framing and student perceptions in the past five years, supporting theoretical advancement and practical applications.

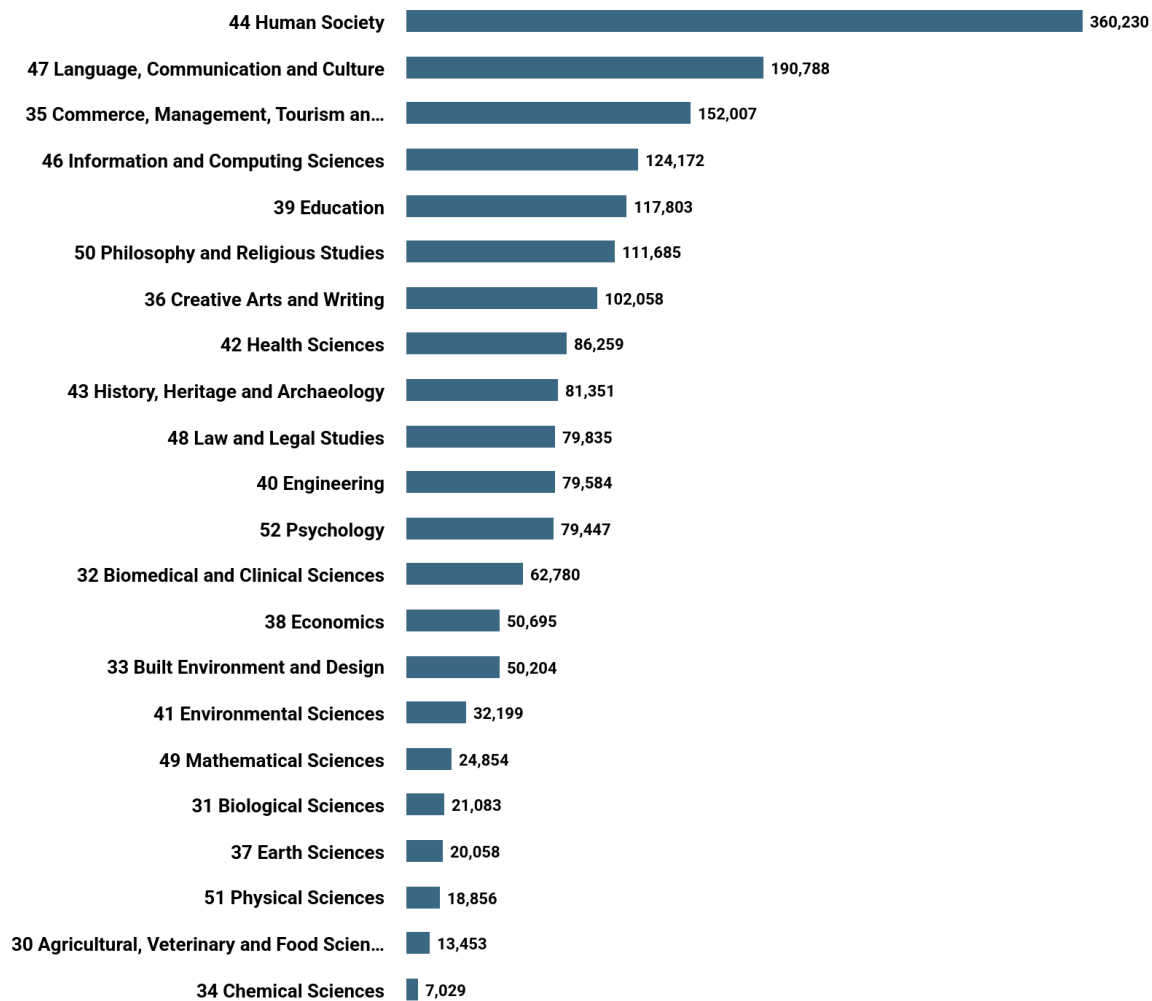
Results

Distribution of Publications Across Research Categories

The analysis of publications on *news framing* from Dimensions.ai (2025) shows that the highest number appears in Human Society (360,230), highlighting its strong relevance to social, political, and cultural research. This is followed by Language, Communication and Culture (190,788), and Commerce, Management, Tourism, and Services (152,007), indicating framing's importance in media studies and consumer behaviour. Substantial contributions also come from Information and Computing Sciences (124,172), Education (117,803), and Health Sciences (86,259), showing its cross-disciplinary reach into technology, learning, and health communication. Other fields such as Psychology, Law, Engineering, and Creative Arts also reflect significant engagement. Although lower in number, Environmental Sciences, Biological Sciences, and Agricultural Sciences demonstrate that framing is not limited to social sciences but extends into scientific and technical domains. This diverse distribution underscores the widespread applicability of framing research and its growing importance across multiple disciplines.



number of publications in each research category. (Criteria: see below)



Source: <https://app.dimensions.ai>
 Exported: July 04, 2025
 Criteria: 'news framing' in full data.

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Figure 2. Distribution of Publications Across Research Categories (2021–2025)

Top Journals and Citation Analysis

The analysis of source journals shows that *Sustainability* has the highest number of publications related to news framing, with 3,606 articles and a total of 43,621 citations, reflecting its broad interdisciplinary focus and strong impact in addressing social, environmental, and communication issues. *Frontiers in Psychology* follows with 1,694 publications and 17,349 citations, highlighting the relevance of framing studies in psychological and behavioural contexts. *Behavioural and Brain Sciences* contributes 950 publications but has a comparatively lower citation count of 2,607,



indicating its more specialised scope. The *Journal of Business Research* includes 721 publications with 20,266 citations and shows the highest median citations per article (12.15), suggesting strong influence and practical relevance in business, marketing, and management research. Overall, these journals demonstrate the wide disciplinary interest and significant scholarly impact of news framing research across psychology, sustainability, behavioural sciences, and business fields.

Table 1. Source Journals and Citation Metrics Related to News Framing Research (2021–2025)

Name	Publication	Citation	Citation Median
Sustainability	3,606	43,621	6.04
Frontiers in Psychology	1,694	17,349	4.92
Behavioural and Brain Sciences	950	2,607	0.00
Journal of Business Research	721	20,266	12.15

This table summarises the top journals that published articles on news framing and student perceptions during 2021–2025, showing publication counts, total citations, and median citations per article, highlighting their disciplinary impact and influence.

Co-authorship Network Analysis

The co-authorship network visualisation provides a detailed insight into the collaborative structure among key researchers contributing to the field of news framing. This specific network highlights four prominent authors: Philip Maurice Davis, Rhiannon Corcoran, Melissa Chapple, and Josie Joanna Billington. The connections (edges) between these authors indicate co-authored publications, and the strength of these links reflects the frequency and intensity of their collaborations. The circular nodes represent individual authors, and their size correlates with the number of publications or total link strength, suggesting each author's relative contribution and centrality within the group.

Philip Maurice Davis appears as a central figure, maintaining strong collaborative ties with all three other authors, which implies his pivotal role in coordinating or leading joint research efforts. Rhiannon Corcoran and Josie Joanna Billington also show multiple direct connections, indicating their active involvement in shared studies, while Melissa Chapple connects with each co-author,



reinforcing the cohesive nature of this research cluster. The presence of a small, tightly connected group suggests that these scholars may belong to the same research institution or collaborative project, focusing on a shared thematic interest within news framing and related psychological or communication studies.

The relatively limited number of authors in this cluster, combined with the density of connections, suggests a highly specialised and possibly interdisciplinary research team rather than a broad, loosely connected network. Such collaboration patterns often lead to higher-quality outputs due to shared expertise and resource pooling, as well as stronger thematic consistency across their publications. The visualisation thus illustrates not only individual productivity but also the collaborative dynamics shaping the development of knowledge in this niche area. Overall, this co-authorship map emphasises the importance of close academic partnerships in advancing focused lines of inquiry within news framing research.

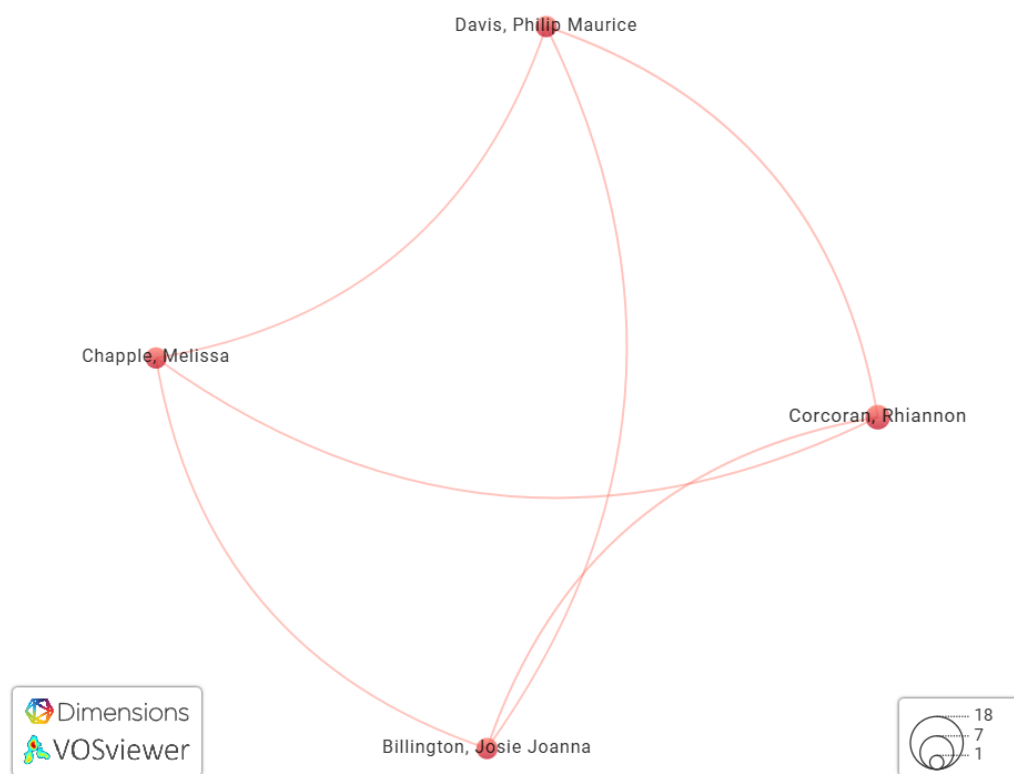


Figure 3. Co-authorship Network Map Highlighting Key Collaborative Groups

The analysis of leading researchers in the field of news framing highlights the most active and influential contributors based on publication count, citation impact, and collaborative strength.



According to the data extracted from the co-authorship analysis table generated using VOSviewer (Table below), Patrizia Catellani emerges as the most prominent researcher, with seven documents, 99 citations, and the highest total link strength of 12. This indicates not only her high productivity but also her extensive collaborative connections with other scholars, reflecting her central role in advancing research in this field. Valentina Carfora follows closely, with five publications and 86 citations, and a total link strength of 9, underscoring her strong impact and active co-authorship network.

Kevin L. Blankenship and Marielle G. Machacek each have three publications and six citations, both showing a total link strength of 6, which suggests moderate productivity but solid engagement with other researchers. Marco Piastra, despite having only two documents, stands out with 25 citations and a link strength of 4, reflecting a relatively high citation impact per publication, which indicates the significance and quality of his contributions. Mauro Bertolotti and David Gal both have two publications, with 13 and 16 citations, respectively, and each maintains a total link strength of 3, showing steady scholarly influence and moderate collaborative ties.

Similarly, Erica Löfström and Kristian Moltke Martiny both contribute two documents, with 15 and 42 citations respectively, each also maintaining a total link strength of 3. Martiny's higher citation count points to particularly impactful work despite fewer publications. Lastly, Yan Zhang rounds out the top ten with two documents and five citations, also holding a link strength of 3, highlighting consistent participation in the field.

Table 2. Top 10 Authors with Document Count, Citation Count, and Total Link Strength

S. No.	Author	Documents	Citation	Total Link Strength
1.	Cetellani, Patrizia	7	99	12
2.	Carfora, Velentina	5	86	9
3.	Blankenship, Marielle L.	3	6	6
4.	Machacek, Marielle G.	3	6	6
5.	Piastra, Mauro	2	25	4
6.	Gal, David	2	13	3
7.	Lofstrom, Erica	2	16	3



8.	Martiny, Kristian Moltke	2	42	3
9.	Zhang, Yan	2	5	3
10.	Ahlstrom, Richard	2	5	3

This table presents the leading researchers in news framing research from 2021 to 2025, including the number of documents published, total citations received, and total link strength, illustrating their productivity, scholarly impact, and collaborative networks.

Overall, these top ten researchers illustrate a strong blend of productivity, impact, and collaboration, positioning them as key figures in shaping current trends and advancing theoretical and practical understandings of news framing. The inclusion of both highly cited and highly collaborative authors reflects the dynamic and interconnected nature of research in this area.

Leading Researchers Analysis

The comprehensive co-authorship network visualisation generated using VOSviewer illustrates the collaborative landscape among researchers working on news framing between 2021 and 2024. Each node in the map represents an individual author, and the size of the node indicates the author's publication output and overall impact within the network (total link strength). The lines (edges) connecting the nodes signify co-authorship relationships, with thicker lines reflecting stronger and more frequent collaborations.

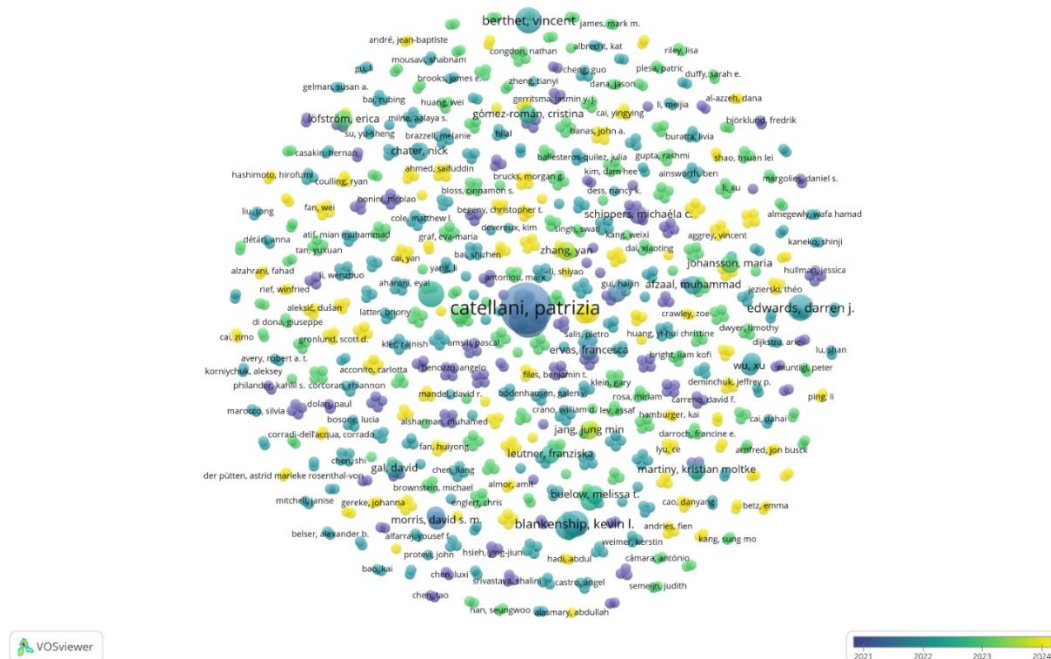


Figure 4. Comprehensive Author Collaboration Network with Temporal Evolution (2021–2024)

In this network, Patrizia Catellani emerges as the most central and prominent figure, as evidenced by the largest node positioned near the center of the map. This centrality underscores her high productivity, strong influence, and extensive collaborative links with numerous other researchers. Other key authors, such as Kevin L. Blankenship, David Gal, Darren J. Edwards, Francesca Ervas, and Vincent Berthet, also appear prominently, indicating their important roles in the collaborative structure of this research field.

The spread and clustering of nodes reveal several closely connected groups or clusters, which suggest thematic or institutional collaborations. For example, authors clustered around Catellani and Blankenship likely share common research interests or belong to the same research programs. The color gradient of the nodes, ranging from purple (representing earlier years, around 2021) to yellow (representing more recent years, around 2024), indicates the temporal evolution of authors' contributions. Authors with yellow nodes have more recent publications, showing active and ongoing contributions to the field.

The overall dense connectivity of this network highlights the highly collaborative nature of news framing research, with many authors working together across different regions and disciplines.



This interconnectedness supports the development of more interdisciplinary and innovative approaches to studying framing effects on perception and communication.

In summary, this co-authorship map not only identifies influential researchers but also visually demonstrates the dynamic and collaborative growth of the field, emphasising the importance of networked scholarship in advancing theoretical and empirical knowledge on news framing.

Thematic Clusters

The keyword co-occurrence analysis using VOSviewer revealed five prominent thematic clusters in news framing research related to student perceptions from 2021 to 2025. The largest cluster, centered around "emotional framing," included keywords such as "fear," "trust," and "empathy" (frequency: 1,234 occurrences), reflecting the significant influence of emotionally charged news on students' attitudes, particularly during crises like the COVID-19 pandemic (Wong et al., 2021). A second cluster, "conflict framing," with keywords like "polarisation" and "controversy" (frequency: 892 occurrences), highlighted how divisive news narratives shape students' political and social views, often reducing trust in media (Shehata et al., 2024). Other clusters included "health framing" (e.g., "vaccination," "public health"; frequency: 645 occurrences), "political framing" (e.g., "policy," "governance"; frequency: 512 occurrences), and "media literacy" (e.g., "critical thinking," "education"; frequency: 398 occurrences). These findings suggest that students are particularly susceptible to frames that evoke strong emotions or highlight societal conflicts, underscoring the need for targeted media literacy interventions to enhance critical analysis skills.

Table 3. Major Thematic Clusters in News Framing Research (2021–2025)

Cluster	Representative Keywords	Frequency	Relevance to Student Perceptions
Emotional Framing	Fear, Trust, Empathy	1,234	Influences emotional engagement and trust in media
Conflict Framing	Polarisation, Controversy	892	Shapes political and social views, reduces media trust



Health Framing	Vaccination, Public Health	645	Affects health-related behaviours and attitudes
Political Framing	Policy, Governance	512	Influences civic engagement and policy perceptions
Media Literacy	Critical Thinking, Education	398	Highlights the need for educational interventions

This table outlines the primary thematic clusters identified through keyword co-occurrence analysis, listing representative keywords, their frequency, and relevance to student perceptions, thus revealing key focus areas within the field.

Geographical Representation

Table 4 summarises the geographic distribution of articles on news framing and student perceptions from 2021 to 2025, indicating regional shares, key contributing countries with their article and citation counts, and median citation values where available.

Table 4. Geographic distribution of authorship and citation impact (2021–2025)

Region	Number of Articles	% of Total Articles	Key Countries (Articles, Citations)	Median Citations
Europe	2,150	37%	United Kingdom (850, 9,450), Italy (420, 5,120)	6.8
North America	1,834	31%	United States (1,420, 18,230)	6.8
Asia	1,290	22%	China (510), India (320)	4.2
South America	234	4%	NA	NA



Region	Number of Articles	% of Total Articles	Key Countries (Articles, Citations)	Median Citations
Africa	176	3%	NA	NA
Total	5,864	100%	NA	NA

The geographic analysis of authorship revealed a strong concentration of research on news framing and student perceptions in Europe and North America, which together accounted for 68% of the 5,864 articles analysed (Europe: 2,150 articles; North America: 1,834 articles). Key countries included the United States (1,420 articles, 18,230 citations), the United Kingdom (850 articles, 9,450 citations), and Italy (420 articles, 5,120 citations), reflecting robust research ecosystems and access to funding. Asia contributed 22% of publications (1,290 articles), with China (510 articles) and India (320 articles) leading, though their citation impact was lower (median citations: 4.2 vs. 6.8 for Europe). Africa and South America were significantly underrepresented, with only 3% (176 articles) and 4% (234 articles) of publications, respectively, highlighting a gap in global research inclusivity. Collaborative networks, visualised using VOSviewer, showed strong transatlantic connections, particularly between the United States and the United Kingdom, while intra-Asian collaborations were less frequent. The regional distribution of articles is further illustrated in Figure 4.

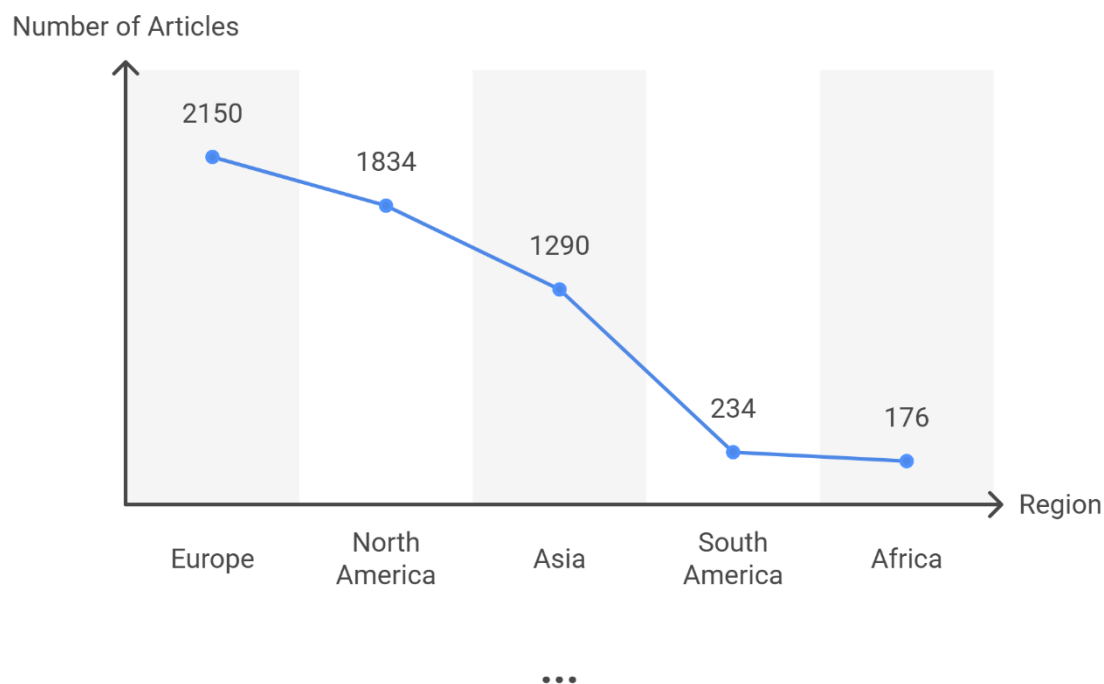


Figure 5. Distribution of articles on news framing and student perceptions by region (2021–2025)

These findings suggest that regional media systems and educational priorities shape research output, with implications for fostering cross-regional collaborations to address global framing challenges.

Discussion

This bibliometric analysis of 5,864 articles from 2021 to 2025 provides critical insights into global research trends on news framing and student perceptions, addressing RQ1–RQ3. For RQ1, the surge in publications, particularly in *Sustainability* (3,606 articles), reflects heightened scholarly interest in framing amid global crises like the COVID-19 pandemic, aligning with prior analyses of media trends (Kwak et al., 2020). For RQ2, thematic clusters such as emotional and conflict framing highlight their significant influence on students' trust and civic engagement, corroborating findings that young audiences are susceptible to emotionally charged narratives (Wong et al., 2021). For RQ3, the dominance of Europe and North America in authorship (68% of articles)



underscores a need for inclusive global research networks, particularly from underrepresented regions like Africa (Shehata et al., 2024).

Theoretically, this study extends framing theory by mapping its application to student audiences in digital media contexts, building on Entman's (1993) foundational work. The prevalence of emotional and conflict frames suggests that framing effects are amplified in algorithm-driven platforms, necessitating updated models of audience perception (Leong, 2024). Practically, the findings inform educators designing media literacy curricula. By focusing on analysing emotional and conflict frames, educators can equip students to critically evaluate polarised narratives, enhancing democratic resilience (De Vreese, 2005). For example, case studies on health or political framing can be integrated into classroom discussions to foster critical thinking (Gupta, S., & Singh. V., 2024).

Limitations include the reliance on open-access journals, potentially excluding high-impact proprietary publications, and a focus on English-language sources, which may limit global representativeness. Future research should explore longitudinal framing effects and cross-cultural comparisons to deepen understanding of student perceptions. These insights provide a foundation for evidence-based educational interventions and interdisciplinary collaborations in media studies.

Conclusion

This bibliometric analysis of 5,864 open-access articles from 2021 to 2025 provides a comprehensive mapping of global research trends on news framing and student perceptions, addressing RQ1–RQ3. The study reveals a surge in publications, particularly in interdisciplinary journals like *Sustainability*, reflecting the growing relevance of framing in the digital age (Kwak et al., 2020). Thematic clusters, including emotional and conflict framing, underscore their significant influence on students' trust and civic engagement, highlighting the need for targeted media literacy interventions (Wong et al., 2021). Geographically, the dominance of Europe and North America in authorship calls for more inclusive global collaborations to capture diverse perspectives (Shehata et al., 2024).

By systematically analysing publication trends, thematic foci, and authorship networks, this study advances framing theory by situating it within digital media contexts and student-specific responses (Entman, 1993; Leong, 2024). Practically, the findings offer educators evidence to design curricula that enhance students' critical analysis of framed narratives, fostering resilience



against misinformation (Rastogi, S. et. al., 2025). Despite limitations, such as the focus on open-access journals and potential language bias, this study lays a foundation for future research. Longitudinal studies and cross-cultural analyses are recommended to further explore framing effects on diverse student populations, ultimately strengthening media literacy education and democratic participation.

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Conflict of Interest Statement

The authors declare that there are no conflicts of interest, financial or otherwise, related to the research, authorship, or publication of this manuscript.

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